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✦ AI Overview



To remove the first character of a string in Bash, the most efficient method is using **substring expansion syntax** `${string:1}`. [🔗](#)

Method 1: Substring Expansion (Recommended)

This approach slices the string starting from **index 1** (the second character) until the end. It is fast because it does not spawn external processes. [🔗](#)

bash

```
my_string="Bash"
result="${my_string:1}"
echo "$result" # Outputs: ash
```

Use code with caution.



Method 2: Parameter Expansion

You can use the pattern matching syntax `${string#??}`. The `?` wildcard matches exactly **one character** from the beginning. [🔗 Stack Overflow](#)

bash

```
my_string="Bash"
result="${my_string#??}"
echo "$result" # Outputs: ash
```

Use code with caution.



Method 3: Using External Commands

If you are processing streams of text rather than a single variable, external commands are highly effective:

- Using `cut` :

bash

```
echo "Bash" | cut -c2-
```

Use code with caution.

- Using `sed` :

bash

```
echo "Bash" | sed 's/^.//'
```

Use code with caution.

 Stack Overflow +1

If you want to tweak this logic, tell me:

- Do you also need to remove the **last character**?
- Do you need to remove multiple characters or a **specific character** (like a comma)?
- Are you processing a **single variable** or an **entire file**?  GitHub +4

 6 sites

Remove first character of a multi-line string in a text file

Jun 17, 2021 — 5 Answers. ... This strips the leading # from all lines from the line beginning with # enable bash completion to the next line beg...

 Unix & Linux Stack Exchange

Remove first character of a string in Bash

Jul 6, 2011 — To remove the first character of a string in Bash, you can use parameter expansion: `***${string#?}***` `echo ${myString/?}` You ...



 Stack Overflow

Trimming a string with Bash | Goran et al.

Feb 7, 2021 — You can use Bash to trim a string by removing leading and trailing whitespace characters. You can use the following syntax to remo...

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Stack Overflow

9 answers · 15 years ago

Remove first character of a string in Bash

Starting at **character** number 1 of myString (**character** 0 being the left-most **character**) return the remainder of the **string**.

[How to remove first & last character in bash string](#) 4 answers Aug 31, 2022

[How can I strip first X characters from string using sed?](#) 13 answers Jul 13, 2012

[More results from stackoverflow.com](#)



Ask Ubuntu

<https://askubuntu.com/questions/bash-remove-first-a...>

Bash remove first and last characters from a string

Dec 23, 2011 — I have a string like that: |abcdefg| And I want to get a new string called in someway (like string2) with the original string without the two | characters ...

[10 answers](#) · Top answer: You can do string="|abcdefg|" string2=\${string#"|"} string2=\${string2%"|"} ec...

[bash - Deleting first letter of each line](#) 2 answers Jan 4, 2015

[Remove the first part of a string using sed](#) 11 answers Sep 4, 2014

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Unix & Linux Stack Exchange

<https://unix.stackexchange.com/questions/how-to-dr...>

How to 'drop'/delete characters from in front of a string?

Apr 7, 2015 — I have a **string** that I would like to manipulate. The **string** is H08W2345678 how would I be able to manipulate it so the output is just W2345678?

[remove particular characters from a variable using bash](#) 6 answers Dec 12, 2013

[Bash: How can i remove characters from a string until i ...](#) 1 answer Jul 28, 2019

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Baeldung

<https://www.baeldung.com> › Home › Text Processing

Remove the First Characters of a Line | Baeldung on Linux

Mar 18, 2024 — In this tutorial, we'll learn **how to remove the first n characters of a line** using the tools provided by GNU/Linux.



Super User

<https://superuser.com> › questions › how-to-remove-the-...

How to remove the first character in a line which contains ...

Dec 21, 2020 — I need to frequently comment/uncomment a line containing a string with "#". For example: CopyDon't touch this line. Touch this LINE instead. <==> CopyDon't ...

[1 answer](#) · Top answer: The proper way is to make s work only on lines that match a certain pattern, th...

[Delete the first known character in a string with sed ...](#) 4 answers Jun 27, 2010

[remove first line in bash - Super User](#) 3 answers May 16, 2011

[More results from superuser.com](#)



Unix Linux Community

<https://community.unix.com> › how-to-remove-the-first-...

How to remove the first character on a string in a variable

Apr 7, 2010 — Does anyone know how to code in ksh that will **remove the first character in a string variable** and replace that variable without the first character?

[Delete first character from a string stored in a variable](#) 11 posts Jun 18, 2010

[sed: remove first character from particular line](#) 6 posts May 19, 2009

[More results from community.unix.com](#)



flaviocopes.com

<https://flaviocopes.com> › CLI

Remove the first or last characters in a shell script - Flavio Copes

Jul 18, 2022 — **Learn how to remove the first or last n characters from a variable in a shell script** using cut, and the rev trick to trim characters off the end ...



TutorialKart

<https://www.tutorialkart.com> › bash-shell-scripting › ba...

Remove First Character in String in Bash

To remove first character in a string in Bash scripting, you can use string slicing. **Get the substring from second character till the end the string**, ...



GitHub

<https://icqoran.github.io> › 2021/02/07 › bash-string-trim...

Trimming a string with Bash

Feb 7, 2021 — In Bash, we can **remove a given character or string from the front** and the back of an input string using the following syntax:

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